CHINESE crashes

Hackers have started sending a malformed message in Chinese characters that crash Siemens mobile phones. The security bug affects the 3568i (or below) range of Siemens cell phones. A rogue message sent to this mobile can render it useless. The message cannot be simply deleted. It can be deleted using a specific software that has to be downloaded from the Web. This seems very much like a sequel to the havoc wreaked on Nokia mobile phones in Japan last year.

snapshot

3 million
Internet subscribers in India as on March 2001.
Expected growth by 2003:
7.5 million

Source: NASSCOM

Security without privacy?

Pacific Northwest National Laboratory (PNNL) has developed a holographic imaging system for scanning people at airports for security purposes. The scanning is done through radio waves. The waves penetrate the clothing and the items concealed within. The reflected signals from the body and the items in your clothing are collected by a computer, which reconstructs the data into a 3D bitmap. Though this is an effective system, the person at the computer can see not only concealed items if any, but also a nude image of the person being scanned. This leads to privacy issues and PNNL is working on a software solution that can solve this issue.

Ultra high speed DSP

Texas Instruments is working on a 0.09-micron logic process that supports nine layers of copper interconnects with organo-silicate glass (OSG). The logic process will produce 400 million transistors on a single chip. The 90-nanometer process will allow the company to push the operation frequencies of its DSP and RISC processors to ultra high speeds. The new process was developed for 200 mm and 300 mm wafer fabrication.

quoteworthy

"Linux can't beat Windows."
Bob Young, Red Hat Chairman

"Internet is 100 per cent backward from what it will be in 10 years from now."
Steve Ballmer, President and CEO, Microsoft

"When a company is very small, you focus on the who, the what and the how... Over time you give up on the how, give up on the what, and focus on the who."
Jeff Bezos, CEO, Amazon.com

tomorrow's technology

Itanium's third child—McKinley

This is the name of the latest server processor from Intel. Covering an area of 464 square millimetres, it is the largest processor ever made. The fabrications will not be easier than the earlier products—McKinley will not be a cheap processor. Intel researchers believe that it certainly is a mammoth task and a great challenge to produce chips of such surface area. McKinley, the third child in the Itanium series, will be followed by newer siblings; namely Madison, Montecito and Chicanos. The processor consists of a substantial amount of cache-data reservoirs near the processor for rapid data access. The chip would be integrated with a 3 MB level 3 cache, 256 KB level 2 cache and 32 KB level 1 cache, respectively. All these additions and integrations contribute to the size of the actual processor.

McKinley would be fabricated with 221 million transistors embedded on it. Intel adds that the success of the processor will depend on the availability of software that can squeeze out the capabilities of McKinley.

WhoIs?

■ Isamu Sanada
A Mac fanatic who has been creating speculative models of Apple products. He designed a laptop which gave a preview of the Titanium PowerBook G4 months before it was released. Sanada's Apple clones are remarkably accurate, down to details such as the CD/DVD drive slot and the stylish cooling vents.

■ How does he define his role?
He visualises himself as another Steve Jobs and would like to work for Apple for a meager salary of $1 per annum, which is incidentally Job's annual salary too.

■ What's his vision?
Apple has been creating PCs of the future and will always be revealing future PC concepts to the world. He believes that one day he will work with Apple, designing stylish Macs. Check out Sanada's work at ***www.applele.com***

■ Animated cartoons as Oscar nominees ■ IBM unleashes Meta Pad, a camouflaging computer ■ Kevin Mitnick to plead for HAM licenses